



A word from the chairperson -

Happy long summer days as the sunshine continues.

We all love the warmth that this brings and we notice a big uplift in people's mood as a result.

We encourage all our patients to remember to keep well hydrated during this warm weather and use SPF Factor 50, slip on a hat and cover up during the warm periods.

NECRET are busy getting ready for our 15th annual "Dip in the Nip" on September 13th at a secret location. This is a ladies-only event and is a fantastic day full of fun, camaraderie and solidarity with fellow cancer survivors, patients and ladies whose lives have been touched by cancer. Details are available on the NECRET website and also via Facebook. If you don't feel brave enough to do the dip please think of sponsoring a dipper - I am a dipper!

Nursing Updates



Dear all,

We hope you are enjoying the wonderful warm weather. We are welcoming new staff members including Shauna who joined our team recently and we bid a fond farewell to Jastine, Mar and Alison and wish them well personally and in their future careers.

The Unit is busy across both Oncology and Haematology services with lots of new initiatives underway.

We welcome any feedback regarding our service as all feedback helps us in our aim to deliver patient focused supportive cancer care to all.



The 15th year of the Northeast Dip in the Nip is Almost Here!

There are moments in life that stay with you forever. For thousands of women across the North East, the Northeast Dip in the Nip is one of those moments.

On Sunday 13th September, we celebrate a remarkable milestone as we host the 15th annual female Dip in the Nip in aid of NECRET. What began as a simple idea has grown into one of Ireland's most unique and inspiring fundraising events, bringing together more than 3,500 women and raising hundreds of thousands of euro to help improve cancer care for patients attending the North East Oncology Unit at Our Lady of Lourdes Hospital. (necret.ie)

But the Dip has never been just about fundraising.

It is about courage, friendship and remembering those we have lost, while supporting those who are still fighting. Every year, women arrive as strangers and leave as friends, sharing laughter, tears and an unforgettable sunrise on the beach. For many, those few minutes in the sea become a powerful reminder of just how precious life is.

This year's event promises to be extra special as we celebrate fifteen incredible years. After registration at the CityNorth Hotel, participants will travel to our secret beach location where they will enjoy a morning unlike any other. Live music, a warm beach breakfast, plenty

of laughter and the unforgettable dip itself combine to create an atmosphere that has to be experienced to be believed.

Whether you are joining in memory of someone special, celebrating survivorship, supporting a loved one currently on their cancer journey, or simply challenging yourself to do something extraordinary, you will be making a real difference. Every euro raised helps NECRET continue to fund cutting edge equipment, research, education and patient comfort initiatives that directly benefit cancer patients throughout the North East. (necret.ie)

If you have ever thought about taking part, this is the year to do it. Gather your friends, family or work colleagues, or register on your own and we will make sure you are part of a fantastic team. It takes just a few moments of bravery, but the memories, friendships and impact will last a lifetime.

Be brave. Be part of something extraordinary. Join us on Sunday 13th September and help celebrate 15 years of courage, community and hope.

For full details and to register, visit the NECRET Dip in the Nip page: necret.ie/dipinthenip.



Researchers Bench

Congratulations to Dr. Sinead Toomey and Professor Bryan Hennessy, whose study titled "Targeting the phosphatidylinositol-3-kinase (PI3K) and mitogen activated protein kinase (MAPK) signalling pathways to enhance chemoradiotherapy in locally advanced rectal cancer" has been published in the journal Cancer Treatment and Research Communications. NECRET is delighted to have part-funded this important research, which identifies a promising potential new treatment option for patients with bowel cancer.



Impact of NECRET

NECRET is fighting cancer every day in various ways. Our approach to supporting the highest quality cancer care involves using funds for:



- Latest Technologies & Unit Equipment
- Clinical Cancer Research
- Medical Staff Training & Education
- Cancer Education & Awareness

Read more about our vision and impact at <https://www.necret.ie/vision>



Chairperson: Elizabeth Summersby

CEO: Ciaran Briscoe

Secretary: Mary P Meade

Board Members: Anna Harbison Egan, Paul Egan, Mark Doran, Prof Bryan Hennessy, Andrea Moore, Prof. Reem Salman, Niamh Thornton, Jackie Quinn and Karen Healy.

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Registered Charity: CHY 19169

Registered Charity No: 20074845

In Praise of Our Volunteers

As a small organisation our volunteers play a crucial role in helping us pursue our mission. Their valuable time and expertise are greatly appreciated. Our flag day collections take place in Dundalk on Friday October 16th followed by our Drogheda Flag Day on Saturday October 17th. Volunteers can join the NECRET volunteer team by texting 086 7773294.



Upcoming Dates

- **August 16th** Bikes and Trikes
- **September** is Prostate Cancer Awareness Month
- **September 13th** Dip in the Nip

More details on NECRET events please visit <https://www.necret.ie/index>

How you can support NECRET

Further information on how to donate, organise a fundraising event or support in other ways can be found at www.necret.ie/donate and www.necret.ie/fundraise